

```
}  
a:visited {  
  color:#999;  
  padding:0 15px 0 0;  
  background:url(images/checkmark.gif) no-repeat right  
  center;  
}
```

And so all unvisited links appear with a small arrow symbol to their immediate right, and any visited links have a neat checkmark in place of the arrow. In this example, only two link states have been affected. As things stand, both the active and hover states will place the arrow symbol to the right of the link text, but there is nothing to stop you defining a custom symbol for those states also.

7.6 Targeting Links with Descendant Selectors

In the previous section, the four pseudo classes were used to apply CSS rules to all links wherever they appear on the page. There will undoubtedly be situations where you need a specific link treatment for a specific section of the page (such as the footer, main navigation, or a sidebar). Thankfully, this is easily achieved with a few more selectors. In the example template links.html, most of the links are contained in an unordered list, but one is within the first paragraph. As the latter is contained in a separate parent element, it can be targeted with a descendant selector and treated differently. The four pseudo classes can be individually rewritten for any links inside paragraphs, by again assigning the colour for each state, for instance. However, it is likely that some of the default link styles will still be needed. In this example, existing colour declarations assigned in the existing pseudo classes (red for unvisited, gray for visited, and so on) are to be retained. Here are the defaults that control all links anywhere on the page:

```
a:link {  
  color:#F00;  
}  
a:visited {  
  color:#999;  
}  
a:hover {  
  color:#333;  
  text-decoration:none;
```